Brown & Brown

The Cheetah: *Since our beginning, we have known that doing what is best for our customers requires constant persistence and vision. The cheetah, which represents vision, swiftness, strength, and agility, embodies our company culture and has served as a symbol for Brown & Brown since the 1980s.*

Back to Basics

Marketing

Brown & Brown Insurance Services, Inc.

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Purpose of Back to Basics Trainings

1. Why RFP Quality Matters
2. Required Information Checklist
3. Building and Sending the RFP
4. Common Mistakes + Pro Tips

Why this is important

The quality of your RFP directly impacts the quality of quotes you receive. A strong RFP sets the foundation for competitive pricing and accurate plan options.

Incomplete RFP = Delayed Quotes

- Carriers will come back asking for missing data, pushing your timeline

Missing Data = Inaccurate Pricing

- Without complete census and plan data, carriers cannot quote accurately

Poor Structure = Missed Opportunities

- You may miss tech credits, alternate plan options, or wellness fund matches

A strong RFP = better pricing, better options, and fewer back-and-forth emails

TIP

For groups with robust claims data, carriers may waive the MQ requirement — confirm with the carrier.

Required Information Checklist

Company Info

- Legal company name, address, Tax ID, SIC code / industry

Employee Data

- Census (password-protected)
- Job titles and salaries (if quoting life/disability)

Plan Info

- Current plan designs (SBC, COC/SPD, benefit summaries)
- Current rates and renewal rates
- Employer contribution strategy

Crucial for Underwriting

- Medical Questionnaire (required for 50+ lives)
- Claims data (if self-funded, level-funded, or 100+ enrolled in medical)
- ATNE (if near the 50 or 100 life cusp between SG and LG)

Producer Info

- Producer name, agency, and commission request

TIP

Job titles and salaries are NOT required for flat-dollar basic life quotes.

Building the RFP Email

What Gets Sent to Carriers:

- Zipped file containing all documents
- Census file (always password-protected)
- Current plan documents (SBC, COC/SPD, benefit summaries)
- Current rates and renewal rates
- Medical Questionnaire / claims data (if applicable)
- Clean email body with clear request for what to quote, or attach a PowerPoint

Email Structure:

- Subject line: Company Name - RFP - Effective Date
- Body: Brief intro, lines of coverage to quote, effective date
- List any specific plan designs to match
- Attach or reference all documents in the zip

TIP

Always password-protect the census file and zip all attachments into one organized folder before sending.

Requesting Alternate Plan Designs

When to Use a PowerPoint for Plan Design Requests:

- Major redesign with multiple plan options or complex structures
- Include clear, structured slides showing each plan design
- Label each option clearly (Option A, Option B, etc.)

When Email is Enough:

- Minor tweaks to existing plans (e.g., adjust deductible, change copay)
- List changes directly in the email body
- Reference which current plan you are modifying

Clarify Expectations:

- Specify if you want quotes matching current plans only, or alternates too
- State which lines of coverage to market
- Note if any carriers should be included or excluded

TIP

If it’s confusing to read, it will be confusing to quote. Structure your requests so carriers can quote quickly.

Carrier Strategy and Timeline

Carrier Strategy (Discuss with Producer/Consultant):

- Which lines of coverage to market
- Match current plan designs or request alternates?
- Which carriers to include in the RFP
- Commission level to request
- When they want to schedule the client meeting

Timeline Expectations:

- Standard carrier turnaround: approximately 2 weeks
- Complex or self-funded RFPs may take longer
- Plan your submission date around the client meeting and renewal date
- Allow buffer time for follow-up questions from carriers

TIP

Always discuss the marketing strategy with your producer before sending the RFP. Alignment upfront prevents rework.

Self-Funded RFPs: What’s Different

Additional Data Required:

- Claims data is required (not optional like fully insured)
- Minimum 12 months of claims experience, 24 months preferred
- Large claims detail / shock loss report
- Current stop-loss policy and rates

What Changes in the RFP:

- Include current stop-loss carrier and specific/aggregate levels
- Note the current funding arrangement (self-funded, level-funded, ASO)
- Include current TPA information if applicable
- Request alternate funding options if the producer wants to explore them

Key Differences from Fully Insured:

- Underwriting is based on actual claims experience, not just demographics
- Carriers need more lead time to analyze data
- Stop-loss quotes are separate from the medical TPA quotes
- More back-and-forth is expected during the quoting process

TIP

For level-funded or 100+ enrolled in medical, claims data is always required. Confirm with the carrier if you’re unsure.

Census Requirements

What Every Census Must Include:

- Employee first and last name
- Date of birth
- Gender
- Zip code
- Coverage tier (EE, ES, EC, EF)
- Date of hire
- Enrollment status for each line of coverage

When Additional Census Fields Are Required:

- Life/Disability quotes: include job titles and salaries
- Flat-dollar basic life: titles/salaries NOT required
- Voluntary benefits: may need smoker status

Census Formatting Best Practices:

- Always send as Excel (not PDF)
- Always password-protect the file
- Remove any SSNs before sending
- One row per employee, clearly labeled columns
- Note terminated employees separately if applicable

TIP

If requesting life or disability quotes, job titles and salaries must be included in the census.

Tech Credits and Wellness Funds

Tech Credits (Always Request on Ancillary):

- Ben admin / HRIS platform credits
- File feed setup credits
- Implementation credits
- Enrollment support credits
- These can represent significant savings for the client

Wellness Funds:

- Request to match the current wellness fund amount
- Ask about wellness program offerings
- Some carriers offer wellness as part of their standard package
- Others require a specific request in the RFP

Other Value-Add Requests:

- Plan comparison tools or member decision support
- Telemedicine or EAP bundling
- ID card customization
- Online enrollment platform access

TIP

Always request tech credits on ancillary lines. These are easy wins that add value for the client.

Key Takeaways

Process Essentials

- Always include complete census (password-protected)
- Attach all current plan documents and rates
- Include renewal rates alongside current rates
- Include MQ for groups with 50+ lives
- Include claims data for self-funded or 100+ enrolled
- Include ATNE if near the SG/LG cusp
- Always request tech credits on ancillary
- Discuss carrier strategy with producer before sending
- Use a PowerPoint for complex alternate plan designs
- Password-protect sensitive files

Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Sending an incomplete census
- Forgetting MQ for 50+ lives
- Not including current plan documents
- Missing renewal rates
- Not requesting tech credits or wellness funds
- Sending census without password protection
- Including SSNs in census files
- Not specifying what lines of coverage to quote
- Sending a disorganized email that is hard to follow
- Not confirming carrier strategy with the producer first

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Brown & Brown Insurance Services

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